Indian Traffic Rules: Safety and Documents

Short reference document for RAG testing

Safe driving includes using protective equipment, carrying or presenting required documents, and ensuring the vehicle is roadworthy.

Helmets and seat belts

- Two-wheeler riders should wear a properly fastened, standards-compliant protective helmet. Applicable rules also cover pillion riders, subject to legally specified exceptions.
- Drivers and passengers in cars should use seat belts as required by law and vehicle design.
- Children should be seated and restrained appropriately for their age, size, and the vehicle's safety systems; follow applicable child-restraint rules.
- Safety equipment reduces injury risk but does not replace cautious driving.

Driving documents

- A driver must hold a valid driving licence appropriate for the vehicle class.
- The vehicle must have valid registration and applicable insurance.
- A valid Pollution Under Control (PUC) certificate is required where applicable.
- Drivers should produce required documents when lawfully requested. Digitally issued or stored documents may be accepted under applicable government rules and systems.

Vehicle condition and emergency vehicles

- Keep brakes, tyres, lights, indicators, mirrors, and horn in safe working condition.
- Do not drive a vehicle that is unsafe or unfit for the road.
- Give a clear and safe passage to emergency vehicles as required; do not obstruct their movement.
- Never drive under the influence of alcohol or drugs, and do not drive when unfit to do so.

Note: Exact requirements, exceptions, and penalties can depend on current central rules, state rules, and official notifications. Check authoritative government sources for legal decisions.